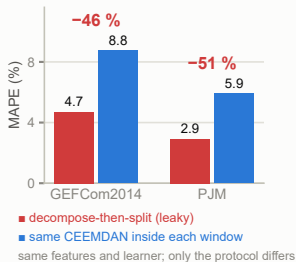


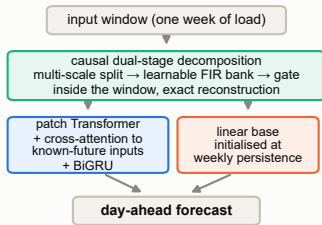
Leakage, not decomposition

auditing decompose-then-split hybrids for short-term load forecasting

1 The protocol inflates accuracy

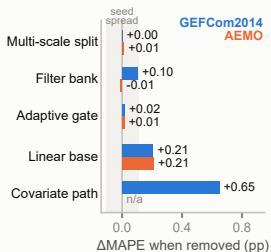


2 Close the leak, then ablate



nothing sees the future, so an ablation measures the decomposition and not the leak

3 The decomposition is inert



Accuracy is carried by a weekly-persistence linear base and by covariates, not by decomposition.

No baseline beats the model at the Holm-corrected 5 % level and it is in the 90 % model confidence set on all three benchmarks.